SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

8 September 2023 · Shift 2

46 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 44 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 1 question

Q.12

A dealer buys some goods for ₹3,600. If the overhead expenses be 5% of the cost price, then at what price should it be sold to earn 15%?

(A) ₹4,347
(B) ₹4,734
(C) ₹4,437
(D) ₹4,743

General Awareness 21 questions

Q.1

The 11th Fundamental Duty provides opportunities for education for the _____ age group of children.

(A) 6-14
(B) 5-15
(C) 2-11
(D) 6-18

Q.2

As per the Census of India 2011, which Union Territory recorded the lowest population growth rate?

(A) Lakshadweep
(B) Delhi
(C) Daman and Diu
(D) Chandigarh

Q.3

In which year were the Arms Act and Vernacular Press Act passed?

(A) 1878
(B) 1879
(C) 1877
(D) 1876

Q.4

In which state of India is Kaziranga National Park located?

(A) Assam
(B) Gujarat
(C) Karnataka
(D) West Bengal

Q.6

By what name are the flat membrane-enclosed sacs present in the Golgi apparatus known?

(A) Lamellae
(B) Cisternae
(C) Cristae
(D) Stroma

Q.7

The Swarna Jayanti Shahari Rojgar Yojana (SJSRY) was launched in the year _____ by Government of India.

(A) 1990
(B) 1997
(C) 2010
(D) 2004

Q.9

'Chapchar Kut' is a festival from the state of _____. It is celebrated during March after the completion of the most arduous task of Jhum operation i.e., jungle clearing (clearing of the remnants of burning).

(A) Mizoram
(B) Nagaland
(C) Jharkhand
(D) Chhattisgarh

Q.10

In which event at the 2023 ISSF Junior World Cup Championships did Amanpreet Singh win a gold medal for India?

(A) Men's 10 m air rifle
(B) Men's 10 m air pistol team
(C) Men's 25 m pistol
(D) Men's 25 m rapid fire pistol

Q.11

In which of the following States was the 2023 World Squash Championship held?

(A) Kerala
(B) Tamil Nadu
(C) Odisha
(D) Karnataka

Q.12

Mumtaz Khan was named 'FIH Women's Rising Star of the Year' in 2022. She plays which of the following sports?

(A) Hockey
(B) Fencing
(C) Football
(D) High Jump

Q.13

Which of the following is a common financial service provided by Micro Finance Institutions?

(A) Mortgage loans for luxury homes
(B) Investment advisory services for high-net-worth individuals
(C) Credit card issuance
(D) Small loans to low-income individuals for entrepreneurial activities

Q.14

The Rathwas, who dwell in the state of _____, perform the Rathwa dance on the occasion of Holi (festival of colours).

(A) Andhra Pradesh
(B) Telangana
(C) Maharashtra
(D) Gujarat

Q.15

Which Article of the Constitution of India provides for a governor for each state?

(A) Article 173
(B) Article 157
(C) Article 153
(D) Article 156

Q.16

Who was the first Woman President of Indian National Congress?

(A) Sarojini Naidu
(B) Asaf Ali
(C) Annie Besant
(D) Usha Mehta

Q.17

_____ was a star of the Kathak dance form described as 'Nritya Samragini' (the empress of dance) by Rabindranath Tagore.

(A) Sitara Devi
(B) Rukmini Devi Arundale
(C) Mrinalini Sarabhai
(D) Mallika Sarabhai

Q.18
Which of the following methods is used to calculate national income by summing up the total spending on final goods and services in an economy?

(A) Value-added method
(B) Output method
(C) Expenditure method
(D) Income method

Q.19
Former Governor of Jharkhand from the year 2004 to 2009, _____, passed away in Lucknow in 2022.

(A) Ramesh Bais
(B) Syed Ahmed
(C) Syed Sibtey Razi
(D) Kateekal Sankaranarayanan

Q.20
According to the IUPAC nomenclature system, which functional group is characterised by the presence of a –OH group, usually in a water-like bent shape?

(A) Carbonyls
(B) Amines
(C) Alcohols
(D) Esters

Q.21
Ajmer Sharif is the shrine of which of the following Sufi saints?

(A) Mohammad Ghori
(B) Mohammad Bin Tughlaq
(C) Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti
(D) Bhaktiyar Khilji

Q.23
Which of the following Carnatic musicians was the first to receive the Bharat Ratna?

(A) Tyagaraja
(B) MS Subbulakshmi
(C) Syama Sastri
(D) KJ Yesudas

Q.24
Which of the following is the highest navigable lake in the world?

(A) Huron
(B) Titicaca
(C) Superior
(D) Como

English Language and Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1
Select the option that rectifies the spelling of the underlined word in the given sentence. He felt “priviledged” to have received the country’s greatest honour.

(A) previllaged
(B) privileged
(C) privilegede
(D) privilaged

Q.2
Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined segment in the following sentence. Hundreds of people were “removed from a place” by the government recently due to a war-like situation.

(A) assassinated
(B) evacuated
(C) invaded
(D) terminated

Q.3
Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the following sentence. Buying a home in the city centre will cost you “an arm and a leg”.

(A) Nothing extra
(B) A large amount of money
(C) A small amount of money
(D) Physical pain

Q.4

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. One who has love for mankind OR One who makes an active effort to promote human welfare

(A) Philosopher
(B) Patriot
(C) Autocrat
(D) Philanthropist

Q.5

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. From scratch

(A) From a skin disease
(B) From the beginning
(C) From utter disorder
(D) From death

Q.6

The following sentence has been divided into four parts. Identify the part that contains an error. (A) Four divided by / (B) two is coming / (C) out to / (D) be two.

(A) D
(B) C
(C) B
(D) A

Q.7

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. The detective went “the whole nine yards” in his investigation.

(A) Measuring every step
(B) Everything, all the way
(C) Close affinity with the law
(D) Taking the distant call

Q.8

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Many soldiers marched in _____ at the international border.

(A) dress
(B) uniform
(C) fabric
(D) clothes

Q.9

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. This scripture / has been /translated in / seventy languages.

(A) seventy languages
(B) This scripture
(C) has been
(D) translated in

Q.10

Select the sentence that has NO spelling errors.

(A) The elderly woman was delighted to receive a bouquet of fragrant flowers from her thoughtful grandson, who had come to visit her at the nursing home
(B) The elderly woman was delighted to receive a bouque of fragrant flowers from her thoughtfull grandson, who had come to visit her at the nursing home
(C) The elderly woman was deligted to receive a bouque of fregrant flowers from her thoughtful grandson, who had come to visit her at the nursing home
(D) The elderly woman was delighed to recive a bouquet of fragrant flowers from her thoughtfull grandson, who had come to visit her at the nursing home

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. She was known for her _____ attention to detail, always making sure everything was perfectly organised and in its proper place.

(A) fastidious
(B) scornful
(C) tedious
(D) exact

Q.12

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. The killing of a king

(A) Regicide
(B) Fratricide
(C) Sororicide
(D) Patricide

Q.14

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. They have less books than I have.

(A) I have
(B) They have
(C) than
(D) less books

Q.15

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Into hot water

(A) Not on good terms
(B) In favour with
(C) Came to nothing
(D) Into trouble

Q.16

Select the most appropriate synonym of the bracketed word in the following sentence to fill in the blank. The sun was setting over the mountains, painting the sky with _____(energetic) shades of orange and pink.

(A) vibrant
(B) reactive
(C) faded
(D) bright

Q.17

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains an error. She was writing / a letter to her grandmother / when the power / gone out.

(A) gone out
(B) a letter to her grandmother
(C) She was writing
(D) when the power

Q.18

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Nonchalant

(A) Flexible
(B) Caring
(C) Marvellous
(D) Covert

Q.19

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Grief

(A) Pleasure
(B) Jollity
(C) Pain
(D) Content

Q.20

There is a spelling error in the given sentence. Select the option that contains the INCORRECTLY spelt word. The profesor’s niece was planning a pleasant surprise for him.

(A) profesor
(B) planning
(C) pleasant
(D) niece

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Tim Cook, CEO of Apple who has recently _____(1) India, has some _____ (2) for parents: limit the screen time for children. He says: “Kids are born _____ (3), they’re digital kids now. And it is, I think, important to set some hard rails around it.” Various surveys of Indian children show alarming findings. A Saurashtra University survey of _____ (4) a thousand children and their parents in Rajkot finds that 92% students prefer playing mobile games over playing outside and 78% students _____ (5) to having their phone while having meals. In another survey by Local Circles, nearly 55% of parents admit that their children aged 9-13 have access to a smartphone throughout the day.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) visiting
(B) visited
(C) visit
(D) visits

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Tim Cook, CEO of Apple who has recently _____(1) India, has some _____ (2) for parents: limit the screen time for children. He says: “Kids are born _____ (3), they’re digital kids now. And it is, I think, important to set some hard rails around it.” Various surveys of Indian children show alarming findings. A Saurashtra University survey of _____ (4) a thousand children and their parents in Rajkot finds that 92% students prefer playing mobile games over playing outside and 78% students _____ (5) to having their phone while having meals. In another survey by Local Circles, nearly 55% of parents admit that their children aged 9-13 have access to a smartphone throughout the day.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) suggesting
(B) advise
(C) suggest
(D) advice

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Tim Cook, CEO of Apple who has recently _____(1) India, has some _____ (2) for parents: limit the screen time for children. He says: “Kids are born _____ (3), they’re digital kids now. And it is, I think, important to set some hard rails around it.” Various surveys of Indian children show alarming findings. A Saurashtra University survey of _____ (4) a thousand children and their parents in Rajkot finds that 92% students prefer playing mobile games over playing outside and 78% students _____ (5) to having their phone while having meals. In another survey by Local Circles, nearly 55% of parents admit that their children aged 9-13 have access to a smartphone throughout the day.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) digitally
(B) digitalise
(C) digital
(D) digitalised

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Tim Cook, CEO of Apple who has recently _____(1) India, has some _____ (2) for parents: limit the screen time for children. He says: “Kids are born _____ (3), they’re digital kids now. And it is, I think, important to set some hard rails around it.” Various surveys of Indian children show alarming findings. A Saurashtra University survey of _____ (4) a thousand children and their parents in Rajkot finds that 92% students prefer playing mobile games over playing outside and 78% students _____ (5) to having their phone while having meals. In another survey by Local Circles, nearly 55% of parents admit that their children aged 9-13 have access to a smartphone throughout the day.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) closer than
(B) bigger than
(C) above than
(D) more than

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Tim Cook, CEO of Apple who has recently _____(1) India, has some _____ (2) for parents: limit the screen time for children. He says: “Kids are born _____ (3), they’re digital kids now. And it is, I think, important to set some hard rails around it.” Various surveys of Indian children show alarming findings. A Saurashtra University survey of _____ (4) a thousand children and their parents in Rajkot finds that 92% students prefer playing mobile games over playing outside and 78% students _____ (5) to having their phone while having meals. In another survey by Local Circles, nearly 55% of parents admit that their children aged 9-13 have access to a smartphone throughout the day.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) habituated
(B) habituating
(C) will be habituating
(D) are habituated

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.12 **(A)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(B)**
Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(D)**
Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**
Q.21 **(C)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**			

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(C)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(D)**

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.12 · Answer (A) ₹4,347

With overheads of 5%, the outlay is 3,600 × 1.05 = ₹3,780. A 15% profit on it needs 3,780 × 1.15 = ₹4,347.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) 6-14

The 11th Fundamental Duty, Article 51A(k), added by the 86th Amendment (2002), asks a parent or guardian to provide opportunities for education to a child between six and fourteen years of age.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Lakshadweep

In the 2011 Census Lakshadweep's population grew by only about 6.3% over 2001-2011, the lowest of the Union territories; Daman and Diu grew by over 50%, Delhi by about 21% and Chandigarh by about 17%.

Q.3 · Answer (A) 1878

Both were passed in 1878, under Viceroy Lord Lytton: the Vernacular Press Act curbed the Indian-language press, and the Arms Act barred Indians from keeping arms without a licence.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Assam

Kaziranga National Park, a UNESCO World Heritage Site known for the one-horned rhinoceros, lies on the Brahmaputra floodplain in Assam.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Cisternae

The Golgi apparatus is a stack of flat, membrane-bound sacs called cisternae. Cristae are the folds of the mitochondrion's inner membrane, and stroma and lamellae belong to the chloroplast.

Q.7 · Answer (B) 1997

The Swarna Jayanti Shahari Rozgar Yojana, an urban self-employment and wage-employment scheme, was launched on 1 December 1997; its name marks the golden jubilee (Swarna Jayanti) of independence.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Mizoram

Chapchar Kut, Mizoram's spring festival, is held in March once the jungle has been cleared for jhum (shifting) cultivation.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Men's 25 m pistol

Amanpreet Singh won the gold medal in the men's 25 m pistol at the ISSF Junior World Cup in Suhl, Germany, in June 2023.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Tamil Nadu

SSC's key gives Tamil Nadu: the world squash event held in India in 2023 was the Squash World Cup, a team event, in Chennai in June 2023, which Egypt won, with India sharing third place with Japan. The PSA World Championships that year were held in Chicago.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Hockey

Mumtaz Khan, a forward in India's women's hockey team, was named the FIH Women's Rising Star of the Year at the FIH's 2021-22 awards, announced in October 2022.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Small loans to low-income individuals for entrepreneurial activities

Microfinance institutions give small loans, often without collateral, to low-income people to start or run small businesses; mortgages for luxury homes, wealth advice and credit cards serve better-off customers.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Gujarat

The Rathwa tribe lives mainly in Chhota Udaipur district of eastern Gujarat, where the Rathwa dance is performed at Holi.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Article 153
Article 153 says there shall be a Governor for each State. Article 156 sets the Governor's term, Article 157 the qualifications for the post, and Article 173 those for membership of the State Legislature.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Annie Besant
Annie Besant presided over the Calcutta session of 1917, the first woman to do so; Sarojini Naidu, at Kanpur in 1925, was the first Indian woman president.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Sitara Devi
Rabindranath Tagore called the young Kathak dancer Sitara Devi 'Nritya Samragini'. Rukmini Devi Arundale, Mrinalini Sarabhai and Mallika Sarabhai are known for Bharatanatyam and other South Indian forms, not Kathak.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Expenditure method
The expenditure method adds up final spending: consumption, investment, government purchases and net exports. The output (value-added) method adds the value added by each producer, and the income method adds wages, rent, interest and profit.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Syed Sibtey Razi
Syed Sibtey Razi was Governor of Jharkhand from December 2004 to July 2009; he died in Lucknow in August 2022.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Alcohols
Alcohols carry the hydroxyl (–OH) group bonded to carbon, and the C–O–H angle is bent, like the H–O–H angle in water. Carbonyls have C=O, amines $–NH_2$ and esters –COO–.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti
The Ajmer Sharif Dargah is the shrine of the Chishti Sufi saint Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti; the other three were rulers, not saints.

Q.23 · Answer (B) MS Subbulakshmi
M. S. Subbulakshmi received the Bharat Ratna in 1998, the first musician to be so honoured. Tyagaraja and Syama Sastri were composers of the 18th and 19th centuries, and K. J. Yesudas had not received it when the exam was held (September 2023).

Q.24 · Answer (B) Titicaca
Lake Titicaca, on the Peru-Bolivia border at about 3,800 m, is usually called the highest navigable lake in the world. Huron and Superior are Great Lakes of North America, and Como is in northern Italy.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (B) privileged
The correct spelling is 'privileged'.

Q.2 · Answer (B) evacuated
To 'evacuate' people is to remove them from a place of danger to safety.

Q.3 · Answer (B) A large amount of money
To 'cost an arm and a leg' is to be very expensive.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Philanthropist
A 'philanthropist' loves mankind and works for the welfare of others, often through charity; an autocrat rules with absolute power.

Q.5 · Answer (B) From the beginning
To do something 'from scratch' is to start it from the very beginning.

Q.6 · Answer (C) B
A fixed mathematical fact takes the simple present, not the continuous: 'Four divided by two comes out to be two.'

Q.7 · Answer (B) Everything, all the way
To go 'the whole nine yards' is to do everything possible, all the way.

Q.8 · Answer (B) uniform
Soldiers march 'in uniform', wearing the dress of their service; 'in dress', 'in fabric' and 'in clothes' are not used this way.

Q.9 · Answer (D) translated in
A text is translated 'into' another language: 'has been translated into seventy languages'.

Q.10 · Answer (A) The elderly woman was delighted to receive a bouquet of fragrant flowers from her thoughtful grandson, who had come to visit her at the nursing home
Only the first sentence spells 'delighted', 'receive', 'bouquet', 'fragrant' and 'thoughtful' correctly.

Q.11 · Answer (A) fastidious
'Fastidious' means very careful about accuracy and detail, which fits making sure everything is perfectly in place. 'Tedious' means boring and 'scornful' contemptuous, and 'exact' does not go with 'attention to detail'.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Regicide
'Regicide' is the killing of a king; fratricide is the killing of a brother, sororicide of a sister and patricide of a father.

Q.14 · Answer (D) less books
'Books' is countable, so the comparison takes 'fewer': 'They have fewer books than I have.' 'Less' goes with uncountable nouns.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Into trouble
To get 'into hot water' is to get into trouble.

Q.16 · Answer (A) vibrant
'Vibrant', full of energy and life, is the synonym of 'energetic' and suits strong colours. 'Bright' suits the colours but does not mean 'energetic', and 'faded' is nearly its opposite.

Q.17 · Answer (A) gone out
'Gone' is a past participle and cannot stand alone; the interrupting action takes the simple past: 'when the power went out'.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Caring
'Nonchalant' means casually unconcerned or indifferent; its opposite is 'caring'.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Pain
'Grief' is deep sorrow, mental 'pain'; pleasure, jollity and content are nearly its opposites.

Q.20 · Answer (A) profesor
The correct spelling is 'professor'.

Q.21 · Answer (B) visited
The present perfect 'has recently' takes the past participle: 'who has recently visited India'.

Q.22 · Answer (D) advice
After 'has some' a noun is needed: 'advice'. 'Advise' and 'suggest' are verbs.

Q.23 · Answer (C) digital
'Born' is followed here by an adjective describing the kids: 'Kids are born digital', as 'digital kids' in the next clause confirms.

Q.24 · Answer (D) more than
'More than' gives a number above a figure: 'a survey of more than a thousand children'. 'Above' takes no 'than', and 'bigger than' and 'closer than' are not used to count people.

Q.25 · Answer (D) are habituated

The clause needs a present-tense verb, like 'prefer' before it, and 'be habituated to' means to be used to: '78% students are habituated to having their phone'.

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